Study Guide

In the style of Edexcel and OCR

How far do you agree that Western powers intervened in Iraq from 1991 to 2003 in order to remove Saddam Hussein from power?

Exam tips

The cross-references are intended to take you straight to the material that will help you to answer the question.

It would be worth re-reading the whole of Chapter 8 first.

The period 1991–2003 starts with the war over Kuwait and ends with the invasion of Iraq. Your essay should focus on the reasons for Western involvement in these wars but it should also assess the motives for Western intervention in Iraq in the intervening years. Be alert to differences in policy among the Western powers and make space for them in your answer.

On the Kuwait War of 1991, you need to analyse:

- the reaction of the Western powers (e.g. USA and Europeans) to Iraq's invasion of Kuwait
- reasons for and extent of their involvement in the subsequent war
- the extent to which the Western powers were acting alone
- the extent to which their objective was purely to liberate Kuwait. Or to what extent their motivation was driven by the wish to protect their oil supplies and/or strengthen their ties with other Arab states and/or to topple Saddam (pages 129–31).

(Remember that motives may have been mixed as well as complex.)

In the years after the ceasefire of March 1991, leading up to the invasion of 2003, you should assess:

- aims and extent of the West's involvement:
  - in UN sanctions
  - in UN weapons inspection
  - in 'no-fly zones' in the 1990s
- how the success or failure of these measures led to invasion in 2003
- who invaded Iraq in 2003 and why
- whether the invasion was launched to rid Iraq of WMD or to topple Saddam's regime (pages 131–6).

In conclusion, you need to weigh up the importance, both for the US and for other Western powers, of driving Saddam from power in each of:

- the 1991 war
- the sanctions, weapons inspections and no-fly zones in the 1990s
- the invasion of 2003
- and overall as the fundamental motive of Western policy towards Iraq in the years from 1991 to 2003.